DAY 24 — PIXLR FOR MARKETING (FREE USER GUIDE)

Step-by-Step Hands-on Practice Guide Using 100% Free Browser Tools

Focus: End-to-end practical workflows without paid subscriptions or premium lockouts.
Target: Intermediate trainees learning practical image editing and promotional ad assembly.
Core Tools: Pixlr E (Free Web App), Pixlr Express, Free Crop, Manual Adjustments, Free PNG Export.
Outcome: Produce professional 1080x1080 promotional ad graphics completely free of cost.

Module 1: Free Account Setup & Workspace

- Navigating free account creation
- Avoiding premium upgrade popups
- Setting 1080x1080 custom free canvas

Module 2: Free Manual Photo Adjustments

- Free 1:1 square crop technique
- Manual contrast, vibrance & brightness
- Free edge sharpening (radius: 2.0)

Module 3: Free Layer Stacking & Badges

- Adding unlimited free raster layers
- Drawing vector badge shapes & frames
- Layer locking & visibility controls

Module 4: Free Typography & High-Res Export

- Free Google Web fonts & text styling
- Adding drop shadows for contrast
- Free high-resolution PNG file download

Free-Tier Account Context:

- Pixlr E works directly inside any web browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox).
- No credit card or paid subscription is required.
- Free tier includes full manual multi-layer editing, cropping, adjustments, filters, and standard exports.
- Pro-Tip: Dismiss any "Go Premium" popups by clicking the top "X" button.

Step-by-Step Execution (Free):

Step 1: Open browser and go to pixlr.com/e (Pixlr E Editor).

Step 2: Click "Sign Up" using Google or free email.

Step 3: On home dashboard, click "Create New".

Step 4: Enter Width: 1080 and Height: 1080 px; name it "Ad_Project".

Step 5: Click "Create" to open the blank free workspace.

Prompt: "Give me 3 clean, modern layout ideas for a square social media ad banner."

Free Manual Adjustments Context:

- AI 1-click tools sometimes require credits; manual adjustments are 100% free and offer superior precision.
- Crop Tool (C): Locks standard 1:1 aspect ratio.
- Adjustment Menu: Adjusts light and colors with zero limits.
- Filter Menu: Sharpens image pixels for crisp mobile viewing.

Step-by-Step Execution (Free):

Step 1: Click File > Open Image and load your product photo.

Step 2: Press C for Crop Tool, set Constraint to "1:1 Aspect Ratio", and press Enter.

Step 3: Click Adjustment > Color and set Vibrance to +15.

Step 4: Click Adjustment > Exposure and set Contrast to +12 and Brightness to +5.

Step 5: Click Filter > Details > Sharpen, set Amount to 20, and click Apply.

Prompt: "Provide exact numerical photo adjustment settings for e-commerce electronics."

Free Layer Management Context:

- Pixlr E supports unlimited manual layers on the free plan.
- Stacking order determines what appears on top.
- Layer 1 (Bottom): Solid background color.
- Layer 2 (Middle): Clean product photo.
- Layer 3 (Top): Offer badges, buttons, and text.
- Shape Tool (U): Creates vector circles and rectangles for free.

Step-by-Step Execution (Free):

Step 1: In the Layers panel on right, click "+" and select "Empty".

Step 2: Drag empty layer to bottom; select Paint Bucket (B) and fill with dark navy (#0F172A).

Step 3: Select product layer and position product in bottom-right.

Step 4: Press U for Shape Tool, select Circle, set Fill to yellow/orange, and draw a badge in top-left.

Prompt: "Generate a 3-part marketing copy structure (Headline, Promo Offer, CTA Button)."

Free Typography & Download Context:

- Pixlr includes built-in free web fonts (Roboto, Montserrat, Bebas, Oswald).
- Text styling tools (Drop Shadow, Stroke) are completely free.
- Free Export Limit: Up to 3 high-resolution daily saves on free plan (more than enough for class practice).
- PNG format preserves full clarity for social platforms.

Step-by-Step Execution (Free):

Step 1: Press T for Text Tool, click on canvas, and type your headline: "UPGRADE YOUR GEAR".

Step 2: Set Font to "Montserrat Bold", Size to 44, and Color to White.

Step 3: In Text Settings, turn on "Shadow" (Color: Black, Opacity: 70%, Blur: 4).

Step 4: Add CTA button text "ORDER NOW" over a colored rectangle shape.

Step 5: Click File > Save (Ctrl+S), choose PNG, Quality 100%, and click "Save As" to download.

Prompt: "Write 3 direct-response headline variations for a limited-time technology sale."

Practice Brief (Free Student Lab):

- Project: Create a 1080x1080 promotional ad banner.
- Asset needed: 1 free uncopyrighted product image (e.g. shoes, watch, headphones).
- Tools used: Pixlr E free editor + free web fonts.
- Budget: $0.00 (100% Free).

Student Action Checklist:

1. Create 1080x1080 px blank canvas.
2. Import product photo and crop to 1:1 square.
3. Apply manual adjustments: +12 Contrast, +15 Vibrance, +20 Sharpen.
4. Add dark solid background layer behind product.
5. Draw discount badge circle: "30% OFF".
6. Add headline with drop shadow: "NEW ARRIVAL 2026".
7. Add CTA button: "SHOP TODAY".
8. Save and download 1080x1080 PNG to computer.

Free User Best Practices:

- Use Manual Adjustments instead of paid AI credits to preserve unlimited edits.
- Save your project as .PXD (Pixlr Native File) via File > Save to keep editable layers for later.
- Export final graphics as PNG for maximum text sharpness on social media.
- Check contrast: Text must be easily readable on mobile screens.

Day 24 Exit Ticket:

1. What URL opens the free Pixlr editor directly?
2. Why are manual adjustments (+Contrast, +Vibrance) better for free users than AI 1-click credits?
3. What file format keeps editable layers saved on your PC?

Expected Exit Answer: pixlr.com/e; manual adjustments are 100% free with unlimited edits; .PXD format.